

Building a simple chatbot

Task 1: Build an action from scratch

You can create actions either by using one of the templates available in watsonx Assistant or from scratch. In this task, you will first create an action starting from scratch.

To start, you will set up Chattie to greet and welcome customers to Nash's Pizza and Pasta.

Select the **Next arrow** to continue.

1. Within watsonx Assistant, navigate to the **Actions** tab.
2. Select the **Created by you** tab. This will display a list of actions you've created.
3. Select the **New action +** tab to start creating a new action.
4. Now, select the **Start from Scratch** tab to create an action customized for specific needs of the bank.

Answer the question

Watsonx Assistant allows the creation of actions from scratch or by using templates.

Which of the following best describes an advantage of using a template for creating a watsonx Assistant action?

Templates provide complete control over the action's design and functionality.

Templates provide pre-built elements that can save time.

Templates require extensive coding to customize the action.

Templates offer less flexibility compared to custom-built actions.

Task 2: Respond to a customer query

In this task, you will create an action called Respond to a customer query. This action will take in a customer request for help with their order and provide options for them to choose from.

Select the **Next arrow** to continue.

5. The **New action** window appears. Enter a phrase or question that the customer might type to start the interaction. Type " I want to order a pizza." in the highlighted textbox and press Enter. You can copy this text from the notepad.
6. Select the **Save** button to save the action.
7. Once you save the action, the action editor will open with the first step selected. In this step, you need to enter a response from the assistant.

Type “Hello! Welcome to Nash’s Pizza and Pasta! Thanks for dropping in! Please select one of the options from the menu given below.” Then, press Enter.

Task 3: Define customer response

In this task, you will define what kind to customer response to allow for a particular interaction. You can allow for different types of responses, including:

- Numerical values
- Specific options only
- Free text
- Date
- Time
- Confirmation (yes/no)

Select the **Next arrow** to continue.

8. To define the customer response to the welcome message, select the **Define welcome message** tab.
9. Select **Options** from the drop-down list.

Answer the question

What are some other customer response types that you may choose?

Select the three that apply.

External link – customers can go to an external link and select an option from that link

Variables – customers can insert variables which keep varying with every entre

Numbers – customers can type in only numerical values

Free text – customers may enter any value

Options – customers can select only from specific choices provided

1. Type ‘Chicken barbeque pizza’ in the textbox in the Edit response pop-up and press **Enter**.
2. In the next textbox, type ‘Pepperoni pizza’ and press **Enter**.
3. In the next textbox, type ‘Classic Margarita’ and press Enter.
4. In the next textbox, type ‘Capsicum and mushroom pizza’ and press Enter.

5. You have entered all the possible pizza options. Now, select **Apply**. The Edit response pop-up closes and the options are displayed.

Task 4: Ask for contact information

In this task, you will accept the customer's phone number to retrieve the address and other customer details.

Select the **Next arrow** to continue.

10. Select the **New step +** button to proceed.
11. The watsonx Editor window opens. In the **Assistance says** text box, type 'We got that, thanks! Please provide your phone number, so that we can confirm your address and card details.' Then, press **Enter**.
12. To define the customer response, select the **Define customer response** tab.
13. From the **Define customer response** drop-down list, select **Number**. This will allow the users to enter their phone numbers in response to Chattie's query. However, Chattie will accept numbers only and not any other text in this field.

Task 5: End the action

In this task, you will thank the customer and end the action.

Select the **Next arrow** to continue.

14. In the last step, you defined the customer response as 'Number'. Select the **New step +** button to proceed.
15. The watsonx **Editor** window opens. In the **Assistance says** text box, type 'Thanks! We have validated your address and card details in our system. Your order will be delivered to your registered address in the next 30 minutes.' Then, press Enter.
16. To end the action, select the **Continue to the next step** tab.
17. From the **Continue to the next step** drop-down list, select **End the action**.

Conclusion

You have successfully created your first chatbot using IBM watsonx Assistant and added actions to it.